

# A Compression Between The Studying Material in History as a way to Deduce State Intentions

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November 24, 2025

## (1) Introduction.....

This research topic is about a subject the reader is most likely greatly familiar with – history lessons. Perhaps, the reader would have expected the existence of certain events relevant to high-school students all over the world, such as the Cold War, colonialism in the 16<sup>th</sup>-20<sup>th</sup> centuries, the First and Second World Wars (written as WWI and WWII respectively), Maoism, Nazism, and Communism. However, this is not the case; in different states and countries, there is a variety of topics being taught. The obvious question that comes up as a result of this fact, is, why? If some events are so important to mankind, how is it that some states are completely missing them?

Our research focuses on three main questions:

1. What is being taught in different countries as part of their history lessons?
2. What does it teach about the state's intentions?
3. How history lessons differ from Israel?

This whole research project started when I asked my history teacher, Sarit, why Israel choose to ignore International and even Jewish history, if it doesn't fit the government's intentions (more information in chapter (2.1)). According to her, each nation (In Israel's case, Zionism) tries to keep their intentions when teaching history, and that it is done internationally – not just in Israel.

## (2) A Review of The National History Curriculum in different countries.....

### (2.1) ~ *Appendix*

In order to answer the first research question – “what is being taught in different countries as part of their history lessons?”, I tried to extract information from the most obvious source of information – the official syllabus of the state. In this process, I ran into the following problems:

- The official syllabus of the state is usually written in the native language of the place. In cases like USA and Israel it wasn't a problem, but for France, Germany and the UK I've had to rely on a translation. I mostly used google translate.
- Sometimes the syllabus is not homogeneous across the state (e.g. Germany) or not publicly available (e.g. China).

(2.2)  $\sim$  *Israel*

(2.3)  $\sim$  *France*

Perhaps the best example of a curriculum that tries to convey a feeling of being wide and comprehensive, but when you dig in, you find a clear bias towards certain attitude. First of all, we need to understand two things about the education system in France as a whole:

- The Final exam in History technically is an exam in both History and Geography. In practice, it has little to do with Geography.
- In the “collage” (France’s so-called “collages” are intended for people in age 14-18) A student in France can enter two “lycée”s (route/course). One is called “General” (French: général) and the other one is called “Technical-Technology” (French: technologique). The History exam Lycée général in a stripped-down version of the lycée technologique exam. The students are divided roughly 30%-70% respectively between those two. I’ll not cover the differences between those two.

In short, the studies material consists mostly of:

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|---------------------------------------|----------------------|
| 1. The French revolution              | 3. France since 1945 |
| 2. The First and the Second World War | 4. The Cold War      |

I would want to focus on how the french revolution. In reality, the french revolution was a cruel event. In the beginning hundreds of (many time innocent) aristocrats (or people that chosen to be called aristocrats) were murdered every day. After around two years, the Reign of Terror in France began – approximately [source needed] 16 thousand people murdered directly in the Guillotine (and 25K indirectly), sometime because they were enemies of the Reign, and sometimes just to convey a feeling of fear and terror. Napoleon

References.....

[1] France’ National Ministry Education; Official Bulletin 22&25 for 2019  $\sim$  [website](#)

[2]